

Ten ways your team can put AI to work this week.

Not theory. Ten real plays — each with the exact prompt to copy, a good-vs-bad example, and a 30-day plan so it actually sticks. Built from a working consulting practice that runs on this stuff every day.

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Find the seam. Hold the line.

START HERE

The point of this playbook

Most teams "adopt AI" by buying a tool and hoping. Nothing happens, because nobody sat down once and built the first workflow. This playbook is that one sitting — in print.

Each play is one job your team already does, rebuilt to take minutes instead of hours. Read the play, copy the prompt, paste in your real material, and run it. Do **one** today. The 30-day plan at the back turns ten one-offs into a habit.

A note on tools: every play here works in any major AI assistant (Claude, ChatGPT, Copilot, Gemini). Where a play benefits from a file upload or a longer context, it says so. You do not need anything beyond a paid seat on one assistant.

01	Messy notes & email → clean summary + action list	10 min saved/day
02	Draft & personalize outreach and follow-ups	drafts in seconds
03	First-pass analysis of a spreadsheet or report	findings in minutes
04	Turn how you work into an SOP or onboarding doc	docs that didn't exist
05	Meeting prep in, action items out	never wing it again
06	Customer replies & FAQ drafting in your voice	faster, on-brand
07	Research a prospect or competitor before a call	5-min brief
08	One idea → a week of social posts	content, batched
09	Job posts, interview guides & review drafts	hiring, faster
10	The weekly AI habit — making it routine	so it sticks

01 Messy notes & email into a clean summary + action list

USE IT WHEN

you've got a wall of meeting notes, a long email thread, or a voice-memo transcript and you need the decisions, owners, and next steps — fast.

COPY THIS PROMPT

You are my chief of staff. Below is [raw notes / an email thread]. Give me back, in this order:

1. A 3-sentence summary of what this is about.
2. Decisions made (bullet list).
3. Action items as a table: Task | Owner | Due date (mark "unspecified" if not stated).
4. Open questions that still need an answer.

Do not invent owners or dates. If something is unclear, list it under open questions.

[paste your notes here]

GOOD OUTPUT

A tight summary, a clean Task/Owner/Due table, and an "open questions" list that flags the two things nobody actually decided. You forward it as-is.

WATCH FOR

If you skip "do not invent owners," the model will guess names. The instruction to flag unclear items as open questions is what keeps it honest.

02 Draft & personalize outreach and follow-ups

USE IT WHEN

you need to write a first cold note, a warm re-connect, or a follow-up after a call — and you don't want it to sound like a template.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a short outreach email from me to [name, role, company].

Context I know about them: [paste anything — their LinkedIn, a recent post, why I'm reaching out].

My ask: [the one thing I want — a 20-min call, a reply, an intro].

Rules: under 120 words, no flattery, one specific reason this is relevant to them, one clear ask, plain language. Give me 2 versions — one direct, one warmer.

GOOD OUTPUT

Two short notes that open with a real, specific reason — not "I hope this finds you well." You pick one, tweak a line, send.

WATCH FOR

Vague context in → generic email out. The quality of the "context I know" line decides everything. One real detail beats three sentences of filler.

03 First-pass analysis of a spreadsheet or report

USE IT WHEN

someone hands you a spreadsheet or a PDF report and you need to know what it says before the meeting — what's up, what's down, what's weird.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Attached is [a spreadsheet / report]. Act as a sharp analyst doing a first pass. Tell me:

1. The 3 most important things this data says.
2. Anything that looks off, inconsistent, or worth double-checking.
3. The 2 questions I should ask whoever produced this.

Be specific and cite the numbers. If you're not confident about something, say so rather than guessing.

GOOD OUTPUT

Three cited findings, a flag on the row that doesn't add up, and two pointed questions. You walk into the meeting already ahead.

WATCH FOR

AI does first-pass framing well, not final numbers. Treat figures as "check this," not "quote this." The verify-don't-trust line keeps it useful.

04 Turn how you already work into an SOP or onboarding doc

USE IT WHEN

a process lives only in someone's head and you finally need it written down — for a new hire, a handoff, or your own sanity.

COPY THIS PROMPT

I'm going to describe how I do [the task] out loud, in messy order. Turn it into a clean SOP with: a one-line purpose, a numbered step-by-step, the tools/logins needed, and a "common mistakes" section. Ask me up to 3 questions first if anything critical is missing.

Here's how I do it: [talk/type through it, however it comes out]

GOOD OUTPUT

A structured SOP a new hire could follow — built from your ramble. The "ask me 3 questions first" line catches the steps you skipped.

WATCH FOR

Without the "ask me questions first" instruction, it fills gaps with plausible-but-wrong steps. Let it interview you.

05 Meeting prep in, action items out

USE IT WHEN

you're walking into a meeting and want an agenda + the right questions — and afterward, when you want clean action items from the transcript.

BEFORE — COPY THIS PROMPT

I have a [type] meeting with [who] about [topic]. Goal: [what I want out of it]. Give me a tight agenda (max 5 items), the 3 best questions to ask, and the one outcome to push for. Keep it to half a page.

AFTER — COPY THIS PROMPT

Here's the transcript/notes from that meeting. Pull out: decisions, action items (Task | Owner | Due), and anything I committed to. Flag anything left unresolved.

[paste transcript]

GOOD OUTPUT

A half-page agenda you actually use, and a post-meeting list where your own commitments are pulled out so nothing slips.

WATCH FOR

Long transcripts can bury items — tell it to flag the unresolved ones explicitly so they don't vanish into the summary.

06 Customer replies & FAQ drafting in your voice

USE IT WHEN

you're answering the same customer questions over and over, or drafting a reply to a tricky one and want a calm, on-brand first draft.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Draft a reply to this customer message. Tone: [warm and plain / professional / apologetic-but-firm]. Constraints: acknowledge their issue in the first line, give a clear answer or next step, no jargon, under 150 words. If I can't fully resolve it, say what I'll do and by when. Give me the draft, then one line on anything I should double-check before sending.

Their message: [paste]

GOOD OUTPUT

A reply that leads with empathy, answers the actual question, and ends with a concrete next step — plus a heads-up on the one claim you should verify.

WATCH FOR

Never let it invent policy, refund amounts, or timelines. The "what I should double-check" line is your safety net — read it every time.

07 Research a prospect or competitor before a call

USE IT WHEN

you have a call in an hour and want a one-page brief: who they are, what they likely care about, and smart questions to ask.

COPY THIS PROMPT

I have a call with [person/company]. Here's what I've gathered: [paste their website copy, LinkedIn, recent news, anything]. Build me a one-page brief: what they do in plain terms, their likely top priority right now, 2 things that might be causing them pain, 3 questions that will make me look like I did my homework, and 1 thing NOT to say. Only use what I gave you plus general knowledge – flag anything you're inferring.

GOOD OUTPUT

A crisp pre-call brief with three questions that land and one landmine to avoid. You sound prepared because you are.

WATCH FOR

If you don't paste source material, it'll rely on stale training data and may get facts wrong. Feed it current material; make it flag inferences.

08 One idea into a week of social posts

USE IT WHEN

you have one good thought and want a week of LinkedIn posts out of it — without sounding like a content robot.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here's one idea I believe: `[your point of view, in a sentence or two]`. Turn it into 5 LinkedIn posts for the week, each a different angle (a story, a contrarian take, a how-to, a short list, a question to the audience). Rules: my voice is `[plain/direct/no hype]`, 80-150 words each, a strong first line, no hashtag spam, one soft CTA max. Number them and give each a one-line "why this angle works."

GOOD OUTPUT

Five distinct posts from one idea, each with a hook that earns the scroll-stop. You edit lightly and schedule the week in ten minutes.

WATCH FOR

Generic "value in one idea" → generic posts. The sharper your point of view, the better the angles. Edit the first line of each by hand.

09 Job posts, interview guides & review drafts

USE IT WHEN

you're hiring or reviewing and staring at a blank page — the job post, the interview questions, or the first draft of a performance review.

COPY THIS PROMPT (JOB POST + INTERVIEW GUIDE)

I'm hiring a [role] for [team/company in one line]. The 3 things they must be able to do: [list]. Draft: (1) a job post that's honest and specific, not buzzword soup; (2) 6 interview questions tied to those 3 abilities, each with what a strong answer looks like. Keep the post under 250 words.

GOOD OUTPUT

A job post that reads like a human wrote it and an interview guide where each question maps to a real ability — with a scoring cue.

WATCH FOR

For reviews: feed it specific examples of the person's work, never just adjectives. AI-written reviews built on vague input read hollow — and people can tell.

10 The weekly AI habit — making it routine

USE IT WHEN

you want this to stop being a novelty and become how the team works. The goal: one AI assist becomes reflex.

THE HABIT, IN ONE MOVE

Pick ONE recurring task from Plays 1-9 that you personally do every week. For the next four weeks, do that task with AI **first**, every time, before doing it the old way. That's it. One task, four weeks, no exceptions. The habit forms around the task, not the tool.

Then add a second task in week 3. Most "AI rollouts" fail because they try to change ten things at once. Change one thing until it's invisible, then add the next. The 30-day plan on the next page is exactly this, spelled out.

WHY IT WORKS

Habits attach to existing routines. "Every Monday I triage my inbox — now I do it with Play 1" sticks. "Use more AI" doesn't.

WATCH FOR

The failure mode is enthusiasm: trying all ten plays week one, then none by week three. Pick one. Be boring. It works.

The 30-day adoption plan

Four weeks from "we should use AI" to "this is just how we work." One focus per week. Light enough that a busy team actually does it.

WEEK	FOCUS	DO EXACTLY THIS
Week 1	One play, one person	Everyone picks a single play that matches a task they do weekly (most pick Play 1, 2, or 5). Use it on real work at least 3 times this week. No tool changes, no new accounts — just the habit.
Week 2	Share what worked	15-minute team huddle: each person shows the one prompt that saved them time and the one that flopped. Save the winners into a shared "our prompts" doc. This is how prompts spread without training.
Week 3	Add a second play	Keep play #1 (it should feel automatic now). Add one more from the playbook. Pick one team-level task — an SOP (Play 4) or a recurring customer reply set (Play 6) — and build it together once.
Week 4	Set the guardrails & lock the routine	Read the guardrails sheet as a team (next page). Agree what never gets pasted into AI. Decide the 2–3 plays that are now "standard practice" here. Write them into onboarding so the next hire starts here, not at zero.

The one metric that matters: not "how many tools did we try" but "how many tasks do we now do AI-first by default." Three is a win. The habit is the product.

AI guardrails — one page

The fastest way to lose a leader's trust in AI is one data mistake. These few rules make "yes, the team can use this" an easy call. Not legal advice — a sane default.

Never paste this into a public AI tool

- Customer or client personal data (names + sensitive details, SSNs, health, financial account info).
- Anything covered by an NDA or marked confidential.
- Passwords, API keys, secrets, internal credentials.
- Unreleased financials, M&A, or legal matters.

Safe alternatives

- Redact first: replace real names with "Customer A," real numbers with placeholders.
- Use it on the *structure*, not the sensitive content (e.g., "draft a reply to this *type* of complaint").
- For real data, use an enterprise/business AI plan with a data-protection agreement — not a free consumer account.

Always verify before it leaves the building

- Treat every figure, name, date, and quote as "check this."
- AI is a fast first-drafter, not a fact-checker.
- A human signs off on anything customer-facing or financial.

The one-line team rule

- **"If you'd be uncomfortable seeing it on a billboard, don't paste it. If a number matters, verify it. A human owns the send."**
- Post that somewhere visible. It covers 95% of the risk.

WHEN YOU WANT IT TO GO FASTER

You've got the plays. **Want them run for your team — live?**

This playbook is the do-it-yourself version. The AI Quickstart Workshop is the done-with-you version: 90 minutes, your real tasks, your team of up to eight — and we build the first workflows on screen together so it lands the same day.

\$497	AI Quickstart Workshop	90-min live build + this playbook. Founding rate \$297 for the first teams this month.
\$1,750	Team AI Sprint	3 sessions over 2 weeks to embed it across the team.
\$1,000+	Seam Working Session →	When the real issue is between teams, not the tools. Quickstart fee credits 100%.

Book or learn more: theseamlinemethod.com/ai-quickstart